

Cyber Incident Response Plan(CIRP) for Organizations

By Rajshree S. Mehetre and [REDACTED]



Overview

- Guiding Frameworks and Standards
- Incident Severity & Escalation Levels
- Incident Teams
- Communication protocol
- Responses by Escalation Levels
- Post Incident analysis

Our Framework-Driven Approach to Incident Response



- Our Cyber Incident Response Plan has been developed with strong consideration for the **National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Cybersecurity Framework (CSF)**.
- We chose the NIST CSF for its comprehensive and widely recognized approach to managing cybersecurity risk. Its flexible structure allows us to tailor our incident response capabilities to our organization's specific needs and risk profile.
- The framework's emphasis on risk assessment aligns with our approach to prioritizing incident response efforts.

Incident Severity & Escalation Levels

It is the one place where the nature, scope, and impact of an incident are all reflected in some manner

		Impact		
		High – System wide Most of the units	Medium – Multiple users Number of users	Low – Singler user
Urgency	High (Level 3) Unable to perform primary functions; lockout	Critical (Level 4)	High	Medium
	Medium (Level 2) Unable to carry out some functions	High	Medium	Low
	Low (Level 1) Causing some inconvenience	Medium	Low	Low

Incident Teams

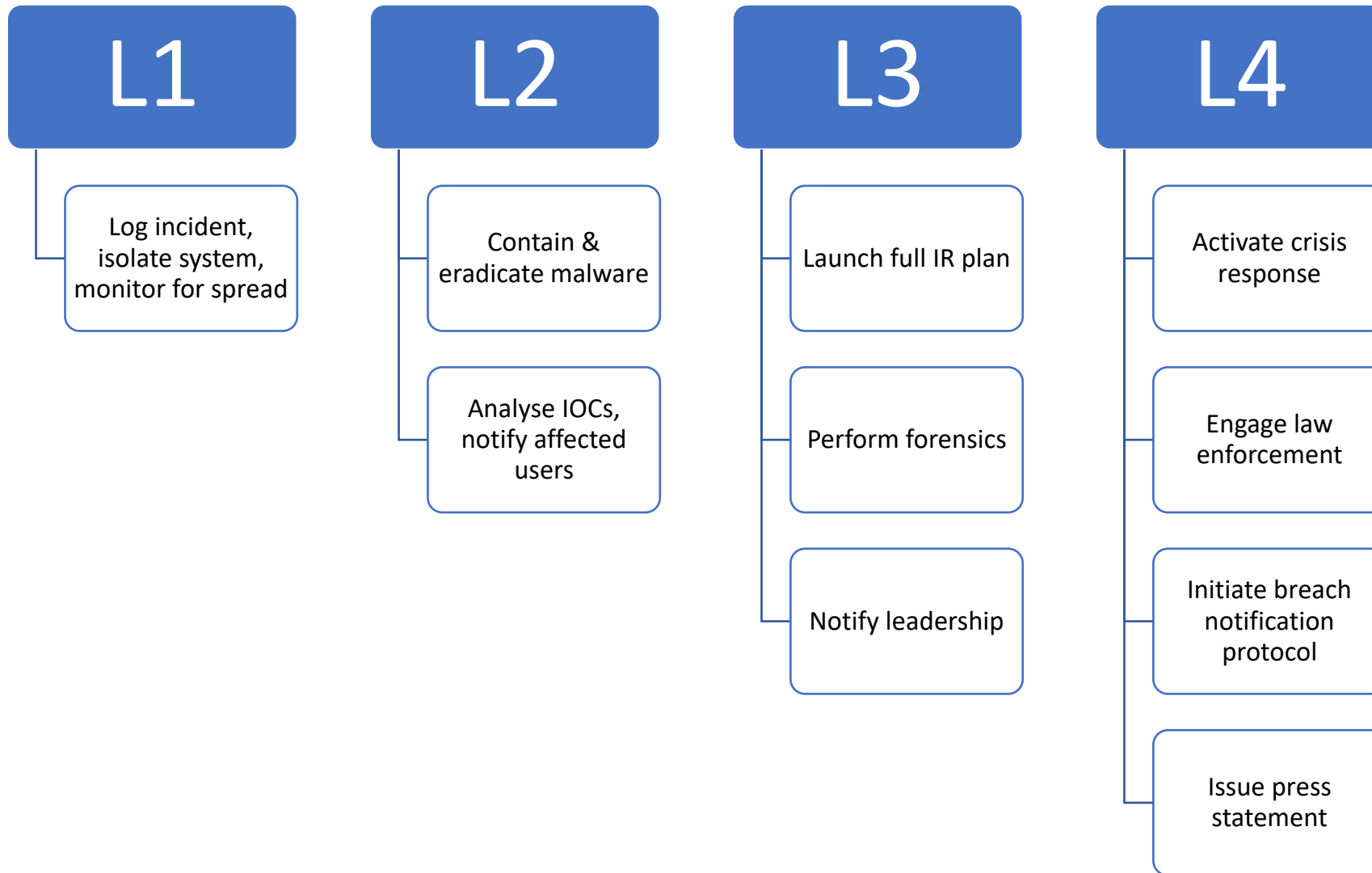
L1	L2	L3	L4
• SOC • CSIRT	• CERT • IT Admins	• Communications • HR	• Legal, compliance and risks

Communication Protocol

Clear, documented communication flows are essential:

- Initial Alerting: Security team receives and acknowledges alert
- Internal Notification: Stakeholders informed based on severity
- External Communication: Legal must approve regulatory disclosures, customer notifications, and media statements
- Communication Tools: Email, phone tree, Slack/Teams (with out-of-band backup)

Responses/ Protocols by Escalation Levels



Post Incident Analysis

Cause & Impact

- ☐ Root Cause: [e.g., Unpatched software, phishing]
- ☐ Affected Systems: [e.g., Email server, DB]
- ☐ Downtime: [e.g., 6 hrs]
- ☐ Data Compromised: [Yes/No or brief details]
- ☐ Business Impact: [e.g., Service disruption, complaints]

Response Summary

- ☐ Detection: [Manual / SIEM alert]
- ☐ Containment: [e.g., Isolated network, revoked access]
- ☐ Recovery: [e.g., Removed malware, restored backups]
- ☐ Communication: Stakeholders notified promptly

Lessons Learned

- ☐ Enhance [logging / monitoring / user training]
- ☐ Patch systems regularly
- ☐ Improve escalation & workflows
- ☐ Run more IR drills

Next Steps

- ☐ Update CIRP Playbook
- ☐ Add Security Controls
- ☐ Plan training and audits

